

Qingai (Sunny) Xu

sunnyxu0628@outlook.com | (858) 319-5769 | [LinkedIn](#)

WORK EXPERIENCE

San Diego Community College District (SDCCD)

San Diego, CA

Workforce Systems Manager

July 2025 - Present

- Lead the integration of workforce and career education data, research, tools, and platforms into the District Educational Services infrastructure to support Career Technical Education (CTE) and Workforce Development initiatives and compliance requirements
- Maintain districtwide CTE data products and conduct analyses to inform leadership decision-making; train stakeholders on interpreting dashboards and research findings
- Collaborate with CTE leadership, regional partners, and Institutional Research teams to align data reporting, research priorities, and student success metrics across colleges
- Manage one CTE Project Analyst and train 4 CTE Research Experts; serve as the district point of contact for regional data requests

Professional Expert 13

September 2024 - July 2025

- Developed and maintained 8+ Power BI dashboards for Perkins V, Work-Based Learning, and CTE programs
- Conducted audits to ensure Standard Occupational Classification (SOC) coding alignment for 490 CTE programs, collaborating with faculty and researchers to update codes
- Automated and centralized regional & federal data reporting (e.g., K16 Collaborative, job placement, gainful employment) using Python for efficient data wrangling and sustainable workflows
- Produced 5+ labor market and program reports using Lightcast and Handshake to improve student employment outcomes
- Served on Institutional Review Board (IRB) review processes and provided comments on research proposals and reports

San Diego & Imperial Center of Excellence (COE)

San Diego, CA

Career and Technical Education (CTE) Research Expert

October 2023 - June 2025

- Led CTE research initiatives in SDCCD, including grant-related projects, and addressed ad hoc data requests from CTE leadership
- Developed Power BI dashboards to provide data insights into districtwide CTE programs, labor market information, and workforce equity for data-informed student success
- Cleaned and visualized large-scale student enrollment and outcome data in Python to meet regional reporting requirements
- Designed and facilitated Python training sessions for 30 researchers across 10 community colleges

Contract Researcher

April 2023 - June 2023

- Conducted labor market research and produced local labor market information using R
- Compiled and cleaned 30,000 San Diego Community College programs' data for the Strong Workforce Program database

UC San Diego, School of Global Policy and Strategy

San Diego, CA

Graduate Research Assistant/Staff Research Associate

April 2023 - January 2024

- Cleaned and transformed demographics & wage data for 200,000 UC professors using Stata into structured datasets
- Improved efficiency by 99% by automating the data collection process of professor publication & citation data in Python

Quantitative Methods II (Regression Analysis in R) Tutor

January 2023 - March 2023

- Provided tutoring in statistical and policy analysis using R to groups of 30 students with no prior data experience

GIS and Spatial Data Analysis Teaching Assistant

September 2022 - December 2022

- Supported the professor in teaching 100 graduate students in QGIS, R, and spatial data analysis
- Led weekly data lab sessions for 20 students, providing research support and guidance on data analysis and data storytelling

American Enterprise Institute (AEI)

Washington, DC

Data Analysis Intern in Education Policy Team

June 2022 - August 2022

- Leveraged machine learning algorithms in natural language processing to analyze Twitter follower demographics, delivering a report and presentation for the media team
- Conducted web scraping and spatial data analysis using Python and QGIS to prepare and clean data

EDUCATION

UC San Diego, School of Global Policy and Strategy

San Diego, CA

Master of Public Policy

Coursework: Big Data Analytics, Applied Data Analysis and Statistical Decision Making, Data Science Approaches to Spatial Analysis, Education Policy Around the World; Politics, Policy, and Educational Inequality

UC San Diego

San Diego, CA

Bachelor of Science in Applied Math and Bachelor of Arts in Economics - Public Policy (Double Major)

Honors: Magna Cum Laude (GPA:3.94/4.0)

Coursework: Introduction to Mathematical Statistics I - II, Applied Data Analysis and Statistical Decision Making

SKILLS

- **Technical Skills:** Microsoft Office Suite, Data Visualization (Power BI), and Statistical Analyses (Stata, R, Python, SQL, QGIS, ArcGIS)

- **Certifications:** Introduction to R Certificate, Introduction to Python Certificate, [Policy Design and Evaluation Lab \(PDEL\) Certificate](#), [Quantitative Certificate](#), [Spatial Analysis Certificate](#), and [Data Management 101 Certificate](#)

PROJECTS

Predicting Household Poverty in China

April 2023 - June 2023

Led a team of two to design and implement a geospatial and machine learning project using ArcGIS and Python, predicting poverty levels across 260 counties

- Utilized household and satellite data, including the 2019 China Household Finance Survey (CHFS) with over 26,000 households and remote-sensing data
- Developed and fine-tuned machine learning models (Logistic Regression, Random Forest, MLP), increasing test accuracy from 0.794 to 0.874 through cross-validation and feature selection

Do Affirmative Action Bans Lower Minority College Enrollment and Graduation Share?

January 2023 - March 2023

- Analyzed the impact of Affirmative Action bans on Black and Hispanic student enrollment and graduation rates using a Difference-in-Differences approach
- Employed R and Stata to clean and analyze panel data from 763 four-year public institutions across 50 U.S. states

Data Analysis Research Report Competition: Apprenticeship Report 2023

November 2022 - April 2023

- Produced a comprehensive 30-page report on registered apprenticeship development, conducting secondary research to identify key insights that supported strategic decision-making